



Over the last few years, there has been massive transpiration of features and performance in the Bluetooth speakers market. This was the case during the last year as well when I was testing speakers for our Zero1 and Best Buy Awards. When the contenders for this year showed up, despite being across different price segments, they carried over features from one to the other. Features like 360 audio, daisy chaining, and the like are available to consumers across budgets. It is not just the features; the performance differential is such that you need trained ears to make it out. After putting each of our contenders in the Best Performing Bluetooth Speaker category to the test, I was able to find out which speaker was the best fit to be crowned the winner of the Digit Zero1 Award and the Digit Best Buy Award in 2023. Have a look –

### Winner: Marshall Middleton

Marshall, as a brand, has been known to make some of the best audio products in the market. And that reputation stood true when Marshall Middleton. While not the loudest of the lot, when I maxed out the volume on the Middleton, there was no noticeable distortion, which started things off on a positive note. Then came the sound signature – It is the best for most genres of music. The speaker boasts a sound signature that is fairly balanced. If you are someone who loves bass-heavy audio, then you will miss

# Bluetooth Speakers

High-quality sound goes around with you



**Marshall Middleton**  
Price: ₹31,999

### DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2023



**JBL Boombox 3 Wi-Fi**  
Price: ₹49,999

some of the rumblings in the low bass, which you would ideally get from a speaker bigger than this. Apart from that, the vocals and the highs, were clear. Between the Marshall Middleton and the Devialet Mania, the competition was tight. There was barely any difference between the two until I got to the battery life. This is where the Marshall took the lead over Devialet. Boasting a battery life of about 22 hours, over the 10 hours of the Devialet, the Marshall edged out and took home the crown of being the winner of the Digit Zero1 Awards 2023.

### Runner Up: Devialet Mania

The overall sound signature of the Devialet Mania was on par with that of our Zero1 Award Winner - Marshall Middleton. The Mania produced the lower bass frequencies well, whereas the Middleton lacked behind. However, in terms of treble, I found some details to be missing, which made it lose out on some points in our tests. The place where the Mania lost the most ground was its battery life, as I stated earlier. But, if you have the money, I would say you definitely need the Devialet Mania on your list of Bluetooth speakers.



**Devialet Mania**  
Price: ₹1,02,000

### Best Buy: JBL Boombox 3 Wi-Fi

Priced at ₹49,999 and offering great sound quality, features, and build, the JBL Boombox 3 Wi-Fi was the winner of the Digit Best Buy Award 2023. There is no doubt that the Boombox 3 Wi-Fi makes for a great party speaker. With its sound signature being on the warmer side out of the box, you can confidently make an impression by playing songs from genres like EDM, Bollywood, and Pop. If you want, you can use the feature-rich JBL Connect app and tweak the settings as well. It comes with all the bells and whistles you could ask for in a portable Bluetooth speaker. The build quality on the Boombox 3 Wi-Fi is also solid. A combination of great build, performance, and features is what made the JBL Boombox 3 Wi-Fi win the Digit Best Buy Award 2023, in the Best Performing Bluetooth Speaker category.

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